Can fifteen projects run end-to-end on Groundwork today?

Prepared against the code, not from memory. Every claim below is checked in the repository or against the live database, and the ones that aren't are marked as unknown rather than guessed.

How to read it. Section A walks through what actually happens when a project runs today, and who does each part — that is the live walkthrough, written down. Sections 01–06 answer the six things you asked for, in order. Where a claim rests on something specific in the system, the exact name is given in `this typeface` so it can be checked rather than taken on trust; nothing depends on reading it.

PREPARED BY
Favour

FOR
Deep-work session · operating architecture

BASIS
Repository audit + live API probe

RE-CHECKED
11 September, before the session

SHORT ANSWER
Eight of ten steps yes; payments no

Three findings that should shape the session

No money moves through Groundwork

A client cannot pay a milestone in the product, and a contractor cannot be paid from it. The only money Groundwork handles is the monthly subscription, through Stripe. Project funds were always meant to run on Switchr, in XAF — that integration has not been built.

What exists is a button that marks a milestone “paid” after money moved somewhere else, by hand.

`MILESTONE_PAYMENTS_ARE_PREVIEW = true`

There is no verifier role in practice

“Verifier” is a word the database will accept and nothing more. No permission is attached to it, no screen reads it, and no one can be given it in a way that changes what they can do.

Everyone who approves a milestone today does so as an *administrator*, which means seeing and being able to change every project on the platform. `verifier` appears exactly once in the whole system, inside a validation rule.

The verification output has never run

When a milestone is approved, Groundwork produces a certificate with a public link anyone can check. That whole path is built and passes its tests — and it has never once run on a real project.

Checked against the live database this morning: **zero certificates issued, ever**. The first real approval will also be its first live test.

> **Philip has now answered the question this hung on.** Fully operational *does* include money moving through Groundwork, and Switchr is a critical part of it. That settles it: the platform can carry project setup, milestones, evidence, verification and updates for fifteen projects, and it cannot carry the money. **Switchr is the critical path to Favour's KR**, and no amount of manual process substitutes for it — a payment recorded by hand is a record that money moved somewhere else.

What moved since 9 September

Re-checked against the live database this morning. None of the three findings above changed — they are the same three, verified again rather than carried forward on trust.

CERTIFICATES	Until this week **any signed-in user could mint one**, for any project — the insert policy was `WITH CHECK (true)` on a table whose `/verify/:id` page is public. Issuing is now admin-only, a certificate can be withdrawn, and a withdrawn one answers "revoked" rather than 404. Still zero issued in production.
SECOND FACTOR	Sign-in now accepts a code by **email** as well as an authenticator app. It matters here: onboarding fifteen projects' worth of verifiers and contractors no longer depends on each of them installing an authenticator first.
CONTRACTOR RECORDS	The CRM was storing form keys — a contact read `role: other` and `years_experience: y10`. It now carries what the person actually wrote, in their own language. That is the communication bridge, so it bears on the comms SOP.
UNCHANGED	Payments, the verifier role and weekly reporting. All three exactly as described below.

A How a project actually flows today

This is the walkthrough, written down, so the session can start from what the system does rather than from a description of it. The middle column is the part that matters most for the on-ground SOP: **who is able to perform each step** is decided by the software, and it is not always who you would expect.

1 HOMEOWNER

Creates the project. An eleven-step form: country and city, what they are building, how many storeys, the rooms on each storey, roof, finish. From those answers Groundwork prices the build against a Cameroonian rate book.

2 HOMEOWNER

Picks a plan and confirms the budget. Self Verify, Jalla Verify or Jalla Management. Confirming is what creates the ten stages and their milestone amounts — before this, a project has an estimate but no schedule of work.

3 HOMEOWNER

Invites a contractor by email. The contractor follows a link, creates an account, and from then on can see that one project and nothing else.

4 CONTRACTOR

Uploads evidence against a substage as work is done — photographs, documents, whatever they have. Files are private and shown through links that expire after an hour.

5 HOMEOWNER ONLY

Marks each substage complete. A contractor cannot do this — they have read-only access to the milestone itself and can add evidence to it, nothing more. **On a Jalla-managed project this is the step with no obvious owner**: the client is paying us to run the build, but the software still expects them to tick every box.

6 HOMEOWNER

Requests verification once every substage in the stage is done. On Self Verify this completes the stage outright. On Jalla Verify it puts the stage into a review queue instead.

7 ADMIN ONLY

Approves or sends back. One shared queue lists every stage awaiting review across all projects — the closest thing we have to a weekly operating surface. Only an administrator can act on it, and an administrator sees every project on the platform.

8 SYSTEM

Issues the certificate. Approval generates a PDF and a public link anyone can check. It also notifies the client, in their own language, and writes the event to an audit trail.

9 NOBODY — OUTSIDE

Money changes hands somewhere else. Bank transfer, mobile money, cash. Groundwork is not involved and has no record of it beyond what someone types in afterwards.

10 HOMEOWNER

Records the payment against the stage, which flips it to “paid”. This is not bookkeeping — the next stage cannot be approved until the flag is set, so a note typed by hand is what unblocks real work.

> **Two things in that sequence are worth pausing on.** Step 5 means a Jalla-managed build still needs the client to advance every milestone, which is the opposite of what “managed” implies. And steps 9 and 10 together mean the payment gate — the thing standing between a contractor and the next stage — is a checkbox rather than a payment.

B The ten stages every project gets

Created automatically when the budget is confirmed. These are the units the whole operation runs on — a milestone is a stage, evidence attaches to a substage, and the payment schedule is these percentages. The on-ground SOP should use these names, because the platform already does.

#	STAGE	SHARE OF BUILD COST	SUBSTAGES	NOTES
1	Land Secured	–	5	Not charged. Land is outside the budget entirely.
2	Design Completed	–	5	Not a percentage — billed as a flat design fee per m^2.
3	Site Preparation	2%	5	Power, water, clearing, site store, first materials.
4	Foundation	8%	7	Excavation through floor slab.
5	Structure & Walls	30%	8	**Joint largest.** Pillars, beams, slabs, blockwork, plastering.
6	Roofing	8%	4	Fewest substages of any charged stage.
7	Electrical & Plumbing	17%	10	**Most substages.** Most inspection points per franc.
8	Finishing	30%	8	**Joint largest.** Also the most subjective to verify.

#	STAGE	SHARE OF BUILD COST	SUBSTAGES	NOTES
9	Exterior Work	–	5	Not charged. The budget covers the main building only.
10	Final Handover	5%	3	Snagging and handover.

Seven stages carry a charge and they sum to exactly 100%. Three carry none. **Sixty substages in total** — that is sixty separate points at which evidence can be attached and a decision recorded, per project.

C What fifteen projects means, in numbers

Useful for the capacity model, and for deciding what has to be batched. These follow directly from the structure above.

SUBSTAGES IN PLAY	**900** across fifteen projects — sixty each. Not simultaneous, but each one is a place where evidence is expected and somebody has to say whether it is enough.
APPROVALS TO RUN	**105 stage approvals** over the life of the fifteen builds — seven charged stages each, plus three unpaid ones that still need advancing. Every one of them currently requires an administrator.
PAYMENT GATES	**105 manual "record payment" actions**, each of which unblocks the next stage. Each is a place where work can be approved that was never paid for, and nothing in the system can contradict it.
WEEKLY LOAD	One shared review queue, no filtering by verifier, no per-project timers and no digest. Fifteen projects arrive in one undifferentiated list.
CERTIFICATES	**105 expected** over the programme. **Zero issued to date.**

01 Capability assessment, by workflow step

FUNCTIONAL PARTIAL MANUAL NOT AVAILABLE — assessed for fifteen simultaneous projects, not one

STEP	STATUS	WHAT IT DOES TODAY, AND THE BLOCKER
Project setup	FUNCTIONAL	Eleven-step wizard, country → rooms → roof → budget → plan. Floor detail now walks storey by storey, so an upper floor can no longer be skipped. Phone, home address and the new-vs-ongoing branch are not yet collected.

STEP	STATUS	WHAT IT DOES TODAY, AND THE BLOCKER
Team & permissions	PARTIAL	Owner invites a contractor by email; RLS scopes them to that project. Two roles only in practice — owner and contractor. **No verifier role**, and no way to attach an inspector who is neither. Philip's answer — a verifier sees only the project they are verifying — makes this a new role with its own policies, not a setting.
Budget & milestone setup	FUNCTIONAL	Quantity take-off against the Cameroon rate book, seven charged stages with per-stage milestone amounts. Professional fees now break into site manager, QS, lawyer and PM; contingency 2%.
Milestone tracking	FUNCTIONAL	Stages and substages with real state machines. Cross-project review queue at `/admin/reviews` — the closest thing to a weekly operating surface, and it is scoped to Jalla Verify.
Evidence upload	FUNCTIONAL	Contractor or owner uploads per substage to a private `evidence` bucket; display is via one-hour signed URLs. No capture standard enforced — any file, any count.
Verification	PARTIAL	Admin approves a stage, which issues a certificate and a public `/verify/:id` page. Issuing is now admin-only and a certificate can be withdrawn — both new this week. Works in test; **never exercised in production**. Approval is blocked until payment status reads paid.
Project updates	FUNCTIONAL	Realtime chat per project, owner and invited contractors. Now mirrored into GoHighLevel, and a reply typed in GHL lands back in the chat — so the team can work one inbox across fifteen projects.
Client approval	FUNCTIONAL	On Self Verify the owner approves their own stage; on Jalla Verify it goes to the admin queue instead. Both paths write an audit row and notify.
Payment authorisation	NOT AVAILABLE	No charge, no hold, no escrow. Stripe is wired for subscriptions only. Switchr is named in config as the intended rail and is not integrated. **Now the critical path**: with money in scope, this row alone decides whether the KR is met.
Payment release & ledger	MANUAL	“Record payment” flips a stage to `paid` — a flag someone sets after money moved elsewhere. The ledger is therefore an accurate record of what we were told, not of what we processed.

02 What Groundwork actually enforces

The statuses, roles and rules below are the real ones, taken from the schema, with what each means in practice. Worth agreeing in the room, because the on-ground SOP has to use the same vocabulary the software does — if a site report says “done” and the platform says `pending_review`, the two records have already diverged.

STAGE STATUS	`locked` — not started, and cannot be. `active` — the stage being worked on; only one at a time. `pending_review` — the client says it is finished and it is waiting on us. `complete` — approved, certificate issued. **The only status Jalla controls is the move out of `pending_review`**; the client drives the rest.
SUBSTAGE STATUS	`locked · pending · in_progress · complete · pending_review` — the same idea one level down. Evidence attaches here, not to the stage.
PAYMENT STATUS	`unpaid · partial · paid` — set by hand, on the stage. Nothing verifies it against money actually received, because no money passes through the platform.
ROLES, AND WHAT EACH CAN DO	**Homeowner** — everything on their own project: advance substages, request verification, record payment. **Contractor** — read the project and add evidence. Cannot advance anything. **Admin** — approve any stage on any project, and see all of them. **Verifier** — **grants nothing at all.** The word is accepted by the database and read by no part of the system.
APPROVAL RULE	Two conditions, both required: every substage complete, *and* the stage marked paid. Self Verify approves in-app and the owner is the approver; Jalla Verify and Jalla Management route to the admin queue. **The paid condition is the one to notice** — a stage cannot be signed off until somebody has ticked a box that no system checks.
NOTIFICATIONS	Stage approved, rework requested, message received, evidence uploaded, support ticket, quote request. Each fires an in-app alert and an email in the recipient's own language, at the moment it happens. **There is no daily or weekly digest and nothing is scheduled** — so a project that goes quiet generates no signal at all.
TIERS	**Self Verify** — the client signs off their own stages; no Jalla involvement, no certificate we stand behind. **Jalla Verify** — stages route to us for approval, and approval issues a certificate. **Jalla Management** — same platform behaviour as Jalla Verify. The difference is the people we put on it, not what the software does.
NOT PRESENT	Weekly reporting, scheduled jobs, per-project SLA timers, inspector assignment, evidence standards, bulk actions across projects.

03 The five biggest risks to fifteen projects

R1 **Payments are not in the product, and manual is no longer an answer.**

The stage gate reads a flag a human sets. Across fifteen projects that is fifteen chances to approve work that was never paid for, with nothing in the system able to contradict it. Now that money is in scope, this is not a workaround to manage — it is the single item that decides the KR.

R2 **There is no way to give a verifier one project.**

The only role that can approve is admin, and an admin sees and can change every project. Philip's answer — a verifier sees only the project they are verifying — means the obvious stopgap of making verifiers admins is ruled out, not merely untidy. Until the role exists, either verification funnels through the two or three people who are already admins, or we hand fifteen projects' worth of access to each verifier.

R3 **Nothing enforces the weekly cycle.**

There are no scheduled jobs and no reporting surface. "On-time weekly verification" would be measured outside Groundwork, so the KR could be missed for a fortnight before the platform showed it.

R4 **The verification path has never carried real work.**

Zero certificates issued. The first real approval on a live project is also the first production test of certificate generation, storage and the public verify page.

R5 **Evidence has no standard.**

Any file, any number, no required angles or captions, no rejection reason taxonomy. Fifteen projects of inconsistent evidence is the most likely cause of verification being late rather than absent.

04 Now, product work, or controlled manual

NOW

- Project setup, budget and milestone generation
- Contractor invitation and scoped access
- Stage and substage tracking
- Evidence upload and signed-URL review
- Admin review queue across all projects
- Project chat, mirrored to GoHighLevel
- Sign-in second factor, by app or by email

PRODUCT WORK

- Switchr integration — charge, hold, release
- A real verifier role, scoped to assigned projects
- Weekly reporting and an operations dashboard
- Inspector assignment per project
- Evidence requirements per milestone type

MANUAL, CONTROLLED

- Weekly verification schedule, run from a spreadsheet
- Evidence standards enforced by SOP rather than by the form
- Payment recorded in-app after the fact — **as a bridge only**, not as the end state the KR describes

This column shrank when Philip answered. Verifiers-as-admins is ruled out by the scoping answer, and manual payment can no longer be where this lands.

05 The sample project, and what to bring

One project configured end-to-end before the session, so the workflow can be driven live rather than described. About ten minutes. If Vanessa brings a real active project, build that one instead and ignore the shape below — a real build is worth more in the room than a tidy invented one.

1. **Create it** at `/projects/new`. Cameroon → Yaoundé → residential → G+1 → about 145 m^2 footprint. Rooms are asked storey by storey now, so fill both floors.
2. **Choose Jalla Verify** at the plan step. It is the only tier that routes approvals to the admin queue, which is the path all fifteen will use. Self Verify would demonstrate the wrong flow.
3. **Confirm the budget and start tracking.** That is what seeds the seven charged stages and their milestone amounts — without it there is no workflow to walk.
4. **Invite a contractor** and accept from the other account, so scoped permissions can be shown rather than asserted.
5. **Upload evidence** on one substage of the active stage and mark another complete, so the stage is part-done rather than empty.
6. **Leave the stage unpaid.** Deliberately. Hitting the approval block live is the clearest two minutes available for showing the payment gap, and it needs no slide.

The G+1 at 145 m^2 is not arbitrary: it matches three of the four Bills of Quantities the estimator was built from, so the number it produces is one we can defend line by line if Philip asks.

Two figures to pull before the session that this audit could not read — both sit behind row-level security and need a signed-in admin: **how many projects exist today**, and how many are on Jalla Verify.

06 Two answered, two still open

Philip answered the first two on 11 September. Both narrow the work rather than widen it, which is the useful kind of answer — but both move items out of the manual column and into product work.

ANSWERED · SCOPE	**Fully operational includes money moving through Groundwork, and Switchr is a critical part.** So the KR cannot be met by recording payments by hand. Switchr becomes the critical path, and the honest reading is that fifteen projects are not end-to-end until it ships.
ANSWERED · VERIFIER	**A verifier sees only the project they are verifying.** That makes it a real role with its own row-level policies and a project assignment, not a permission toggle. It also rules out the stopgap of granting verifiers admin, since an admin sees everything.
STILL OPEN	**What counts as sufficient evidence for a milestone?** Until it is written down the platform cannot enforce it, and inconsistent evidence is the likeliest cause of a late weekly verification.
STILL OPEN	**Who is on call when verification slips?** The system notifies. It does not escalate, and nothing chases.

> **What the two answers cost.** Before them, both gaps had a manual bridge and the KR was reachable on process alone. After them, the KR needs two pieces of product: the Switchr integration and a project-scoped verifier role. Neither is large on its own; both are now on the critical path, and the meeting should put dates and owners on them rather than on the workarounds they replace.

Assessment produced by auditing the repository and probing the live API read-only, first on 9 September and re-checked on the 11th. Statuses reflect the code as deployed, including this week's work: support tickets, contractor contact privacy, the chat ↔ GoHighLevel bridge, certificate integrity, and email as a second factor. Anything this audit could not read from outside is marked unknown rather than estimated.